Terms Isa's documents use without defining

Second Star Collective · Isa team · November 4, 2026

> Isa explains terms only in ISACA's own words. While checking her documents, we found 21 terms that the documents use but don't define, so she can't explain them yet, and one term chapter leaders need that the documents don't use (quorum). Would ISACA be willing to provide or approve a short definition for any of them?
>
> - Each row shows where the term appears and why a definition would help a chapter leader.
> - If there are other terms new leaders often ask you about, we'd be glad to add them.
> - Beyond the terms ISACA's documents already use, we left out tax and legal terms on purpose: their meaning changes from country to country, and Isa passes those questions to a person.

Where. "Guidebook" is the Chapter Leader Guidebook: President (August 2026). "Agreement" is the Chapter Affiliation Agreement (2024 template). Other names are the documents' own titles.

Governance

TERM	WHERE IT APPEARS	WHY A DEFINITION WOULD HELP
AGM (Annual General Meeting)	Guidebook pp. 6, 8, 13, 14; Compliance Framework (AGM minutes)	The documents expand the letters but don't say what the AGM is for, or what must happen at it. Several deadlines are counted from it.
Bylaws	Guidebook pp. 2–4, 6–8, 11; Compliance Framework; Common Tasks; Agreement	The Agreement's definition is circular ("the Chapter's bylaws"). A sentence on what bylaws cover, and how they relate to ISACA's own rules, would help.
Minutes	Compliance Framework; Core Roles (Secretary); Common Tasks; Agreement	Required evidence for compliance, but what they must record isn't said.
Ex officio	Guidebook pp. 2, 3	Presidents are "ex-officio members" of the SAC and of committees. Plain words would help readers whose first language isn't English.
Nominating Committee	Guidebook p. 3	Named, but its role isn't described.
Fiduciary oversight	Guidebook pp. 5, 6	A legal-sounding term that new leaders may not know.
Legal entity; good standing	Guidebook p. 3; Compliance Framework; Agreement	Required for compliance, but neither is explained.

Money and compliance

TERM	WHERE IT APPEARS	WHY A DEFINITION WOULD HELP
External audit	Compliance Framework; Guidebook pp. 6, 13; Common Tasks; Agreement	One of four accepted kinds of financial evidence; the differences between the four aren't explained.

TERM	WHERE IT APPEARS	WHY A DEFINITION WOULD HELP
External financial review	Compliance Framework; Core Roles; Common Tasks	Same as above.
Compilation (compilation report)	Compliance Framework; Common Tasks; Agreement	Needs ISACA's advance approval, but what a compilation is isn't said.
Financial verification letter	Compliance Framework; Guidebook pp. 6, 13	Uses ISACA's template; what it confirms isn't said.
Fiscal year	Compliance Framework	The documents rely on it for deadlines; whether ISACA means the chapter's own fiscal year isn't stated.
Directors & Officers (D&O) insurance	Compliance Framework	What it covers, in a sentence.
Dual authorization	Guidebook p. 5	Recommended for disbursements; a short definition would help treasurers.
Reserves; reserve shortfalls	Guidebook p. 5	Used without explanation.
Willingness to Serve Agreement	Compliance Framework; Guidebook p. 13	Required evidence; what it is isn't said.
Conflict of Interest Statement	Compliance Framework; Guidebook p. 13	Same as above.

ISACA's people and systems

TERM	WHERE IT APPEARS	WHY A DEFINITION WOULD HELP
Chapter Experience team	Guidebook pp. 2, 8, 13	Who they are and what they help with. Leaders are told to contact them.
ISACA Support	Guidebook pp. 2, 8, 13; Common Tasks	How it differs from the Chapter Experience team.
ISACA Global	Guidebook pp. 2, 3, 6, 10, 12, 13; Compliance Framework; Core Roles; Common Tasks	Used throughout; one sentence on what it refers to.
Event Manager	Systems Overview; Common Tasks	Named as the place to manage events, but not described.

A term leaders need that ISACA's documents don't use

TERM	NOTE
Quorum	Not in any of ISACA's documents we have. Chapter boards need it for meetings and elections, and it is usually set by each chapter's bylaws. Should Isa give a general definition, or point leaders to their own chapter's bylaws?